



Amazon's Ring Lawsuit

Dozens of people are suing Ring after smart camera hack leads to death threats, racial slurs and blackmail. <http://digit.in/jan21-57>



Google Short Videos

Google tests new feature that will display short-videos from Instagram and TikTok onto their search carousel. <http://digit.in/jan21-58>



ROBOTS

The evolution of robots through the ages

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he word 'robot' conjures up an array of images in most people's mind that include fictional bots

popularised in media such as R2D2 or C3PO from Star Wars or simple humanoid machines that carry out a set of tasks. The robots that we have in real life today are highly advanced technological innovations that are powered by Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning to give them a 'brain' of their own which helps them learn and get better at performing tasks, finding out patterns and trends, and more. Robots have now become ubiquitous, with them being used in factories to automate manufacturing processes, all the way to the robots that live in our living rooms, be it in smart speakers, smart TVs and even your smartphone assistant, that answer our questions, carry out basic tasks and more. Humans have been

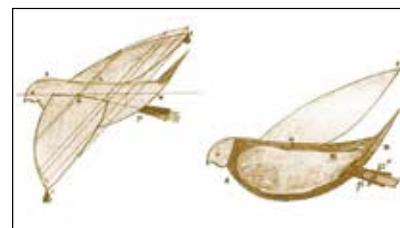
developing robotics for hundreds of years, and the journey is a rather fascinating one. Let's delve right into the history of robots and the evolution in the branch of robotics engineering that led to the intelligent robots we have today.

EARLY BEGINNINGS

Several sources attest to the popularity of robots in the ancient and Medieval times. Ancient Greeks and Romans were said to have developed simple automata (simple machines that resemble humans) to use as tools, toys and even as part of religious ceremonies. The Egyptian water clock is widely regarded as one of the first instances of 'robotics' in human history. The oldest water clock dates all the way back to 1500 BCE and was found in the tomb of Amenhotep I, an Egyptian King. The water clock allowed people to tell time by water falling in a measurement container at a constant rate. Human figurines were propelled by the force of the water to strike hour bells that allowed people to tell time. Greeks also began using water clocks by 325 BCE. The next advancement came in 350 BCE when the Greek mathematician,

Archytas built a mechanical bird, dubbed The Pigeon, that was propelled in the air using steam.

The first humanoid robots were designed in the year 1495 by Leonardo Da Vinci. The first mechanical human designed by Da Vinci resembled an armoured knight and the mechanisms inside, which including pulleys and cables, allowed 'The Robot Knight' to 'walk' around. After that, between 1500 and 1800, numerous automata and automated objects were built based on increasingly sophisticated mechanical principles. For example, in 1557, Juanelo Turriano (born Giovanni Torriani), an Italo-Spanish clockmaker, engineer and mathematician, is said to have built a wooden robot that could walk down the street and fetch bread and meat from a vendor.



The Pigeon built by Archytas in 350 BCE was one of the first 'robots'

Image Credit: Ancient Origins

THE EVOLUTION OF AUTOMATION

We started witnessing the evolution of modern automation in the 17th century with more advanced and